



Administer a billing and settlement plan

D2.TTA.CL2.02

Assessor Manual



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Assessor Manual

Project Base

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Competency Based Assessment (CBA) – An Introduction for Assessors

Assessment is the process of identifying a participant's current knowledge, skills and attitudes sets against all elements of competency within a unit of competency.

Suggested Assessment Methods

For each unit of competency a number of assessment tools have been identified including:

- Work Projects
- Oral Questions
- Written Questions
- Third Party Statements
- Observation Checklists.

Instructions and Evidence Recording Sheets have been identified in this Assessment Manual for use by Assessors.

Alternative Assessment Methods

Whilst the above mentioned assessment methods are suggested assessment methods, the assessor may use an alternate method of assessment taking into account:

- a) The nature of the unit
- b) The strengths of participants
- c) The number of participants in the class
- d) Time required to complete assessments
- e) Time dedicated to assessment
- f) Equipment and resources required.

Alternate assessment methods include:

- Practical demonstrations
- Practical demonstrations in simulated work conditions
- Problem solving
- Portfolios of evidence
- Critical incident reports
- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Interviews
- Videos
- Visuals/slides/audiotapes
- Case studies

- Log books
- Projects and Role plays
- Group projects
- Recognition of Prior Learning.

Whilst there is no specific instruction or evidence collection documents for all the alternative assessment methods, assessors can record competency in the 'Other' section within the 'Competency Recording Sheet'.

Selection of Assessment Methods

Each assessor will determine the combination of Assessment Methods to be used to determine Competency for each Competency Unit on a student by student basis.

'Sufficient' evidence to support the 'Pass Competent'/'Not Yet Competent' decision must be captured.

In practice this means a minimum of 2 – 3 Assessment Methods for each candidate for each Competency Element is suggested.

At least one method should provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence.

The following assessment methods deemed to provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence include:

- Practical Work Projects
- Third Party Statement
- Observation Checklist.

Assessing Competency

Competency based assessment does not award grades, but simply identifies if the participant has the knowledge, skills and attitudes to undertake the required task to the specified standard.

Therefore, when assessing competency, an assessor has two possible results that can be awarded:

- 'Pass Competent' (PC)
- 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

Pass Competent (PC)

If the participant is able to successfully answer or demonstrate what is required, to the expected standards of the performance criteria, they will be deemed as 'Pass Competent' (PC).

The assessor will award a 'Pass Competent' (PC) if they feel the participant has the necessary knowledge, skills and attitudes in all assessment tasks for a unit.

Not Yet Competent' (NYC)

If the participant is unable to answer or demonstrate competency to the desired standard, they will be deemed to be 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

This does not mean the participant will need to complete all the assessment tasks again. The focus will be on the specific assessment tasks that were not performed to the expected standards.

The participant may be required to:

- a) Undertake further training or instruction
- b) Undertake the assessment task again until they are deemed to be 'Pass Competent'.

Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System

The 'Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System', also known as the 'RQFSRS' is the overriding educational framework for the ASEAN region.

The purpose of this framework is to provide:

- A standardised teaching and assessment framework
- Mutual recognition of participant achievement across the ASEAN region. This includes achievement in individual Units of Competency or qualifications as a whole.

The role of the 'RQFSRS' is to provide, ensure and maintain 'quality assurance' across all countries and educational providers across the ASEAN region

Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL)

Recognition of Prior Learning is the process that gives current industry professionals who do not have a formal qualification, the opportunity to benchmark their extensive skills and experience against the standards set out in each unit of competency/subject.

This process is a learning and assessment pathway which encompasses:

- Recognition of Current Competencies (RCC)
- Skills auditing
- Gap analysis and training
- Credit transfer.

Code of Practice for Assessors

This Code of Practice provides:

- Assessors with direction on the standard of practice expected of them
- Candidates with assurance of the standards of practice expected of assessors
- Employers with assurance of the standards maintained in the conduct of assessment.

The Code detailed below is based on the International Code of Ethics and Practice (The National Council for Measurement in Education [NCME]):

- The differing needs and requirements of the person being assessed, the local enterprise and/or industry are identified and handled with sensitivity
- Potential forms of conflict of interest in the assessment process and/or outcomes are identified and appropriate referrals are made, if necessary
- All forms of harassment are avoided throughout the planning, conducting, reviewing and reporting of the assessment outcomes

- The rights of the candidate are protected during and after the assessment
- Personal and interpersonal factors that are not relevant to the assessment of competency must not influence the assessment outcomes
- The candidate is made aware of rights and process of appeal
- Evidence that is gathered during the assessment is verified for validity, reliability, authenticity, sufficiency and currency
- Assessment decisions are based on available evidence that can be produced and verified by another assessor
- Assessments are conducted within the boundaries of the assessment system policies and procedures
- Formal agreement is obtained from both the candidate and the assessor that the assessment was carried out in accordance with agreed procedures
- The candidate is informed of all assessment reporting processes prior to the assessment
- The candidate is informed of all known potential consequences of decisions arising from an assessment, prior to the assessment
- Confidentiality is maintained regarding assessment results
- The assessment results are used consistently with the purposes explained to the candidate
- Opportunities are created for technical assistance in planning, conducting and reviewing assessment procedures and outcomes.

Instructions and Checklist for Assessors

Instructions

General instructions for the assessment:

- Assessment should be conducted at a scheduled time that has been notified to the candidate
- Facilitators must ensure participants are made aware of the need to complete assessments and attend assessment sessions
- If a participant is unable to attend a scheduled session, they must make arrangements with the Assessor to undertake the assessment at an alternative time
- At the end of the assessment the Assessor must give feedback and advise the participant on their PC/NYC status
- Complete the relevant documentation and submit to the appropriate department.

Preparation

- Gain familiarity with the Unit of Competency, Elements of Competency and the Performance Criteria expected
- Study details assessment documentation and requirements
- Brief candidate regarding all assessment criteria and requirements.

Briefing Checklist

- Begin the assessment by implementing the following checklist and then invite the candidate to proceed with assessment.

Checklist for Assessors

Prior to the assessment I have:	Tick (✓)	Remarks
Ensured the candidate is informed about the venue and schedule of assessment.		
Received current copies of the performance criteria to be assessed, assessment plan, evidence gathering plan, assessment checklist, appeal form and the company's standard operating procedures (SOP).		
Reviewed the performance criteria and evidence plan to ensure I clearly understood the instructions and the requirements of the assessment process.		
Identified and accommodated any special needs of the candidate.		
Checked the set-up and resources for the assessment.		
During the assessment I have:		
Introduced myself and confirmed identities of candidates.		
Put candidates at ease by being friendly and helpful.		
Explained to candidates the purpose, context and benefits of the assessment.		
Ensured candidates understood the assessment process and all attendant procedures.		
Provided candidates with an overview of performance criteria to be assessed.		
Explained the results reporting procedure.		
Encouraged candidates to seek clarifications if in doubt.		
Asked candidates for feedback on the assessment.		
Explained legal, safety and ethical issues, if applicable.		
After the assessment I have:		
Ensured candidate is given constructive feedback.		
Completed and signed the assessment record.		
Thanked candidate for participating in the assessment.		

Instructions for Recording Competency

Specifications for Recording Competency

The following specifications apply to the preparation of Evidence Gathering Plans:

- A Competency Recording Sheet must be prepared for each candidate to ensure and demonstrate all Performance Criteria and Competency Elements are appropriately assessed. This Sheet indicates how the Assessor will gather evidence during their assessment of each candidate
- This Competency Recording Sheet is located at the end of the Assessment Plan
- It is the overriding document to record competency
- The Assessor may vary the Competency Recording Sheet to accommodate practical and individual candidate and/or workplace needs
- Assessor must place a tick (✓) in the 'Assessment Method' columns to identify the methods of assessment to be used for each candidate
- Multiple Competency Elements/Performance Criteria may be assessed at the one time, where appropriate
- The assessor and participant should sign and date the Competency Recording Sheet, when all forms of evidence and assessment have been completed
- The assessor may provide and feedback or clarify questions which the participant may have in regards to the assessment grade or findings
- All documents used to capture evidence must be retained, and attached to the Competency Recording Sheet for each candidate for each Competency Unit.

Instructions for Different Assessment Methods

Specifications for Work Project Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of work projects.

The work projects identified in the Training Manuals involve a range of tasks, to be performed at the discretion of the Assessor.

Work project tasks can be completed through any form of assessment as identified in the Trainer and Trainee Manuals and stated at the start of this section.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Review the Work Projects at the end of each 'Element of Competency' in the Trainee Manual to ensure you understand the content and what is expected
- Prepare sufficient resources for the completion of work activities including:
 - Time – whether in scheduled delivery hours or suggested time participants to spend outside of class hours
 - Resources – this may involve technical equipment, computer, internet access, stationery and other supplementary materials and documents
- Prepare assessment location (if done in class) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Work Projects assessment to candidate, at the start of each Element of Competency. This ensures that participants are aware of what is expected and can collate information as delivery takes place

- Assessors can use the following phrase as a guide (where an 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):
 "At the end of each Element of Competency there are Work Projects which must be completed. These projects require different tasks that must be completed.
 These work projects are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X:
- You are required to complete these activities:
 - Using the 'X' method of assessment*
 - At 'X' location*
 - You will have 'X time period' for this assessment*
 - You are required to compile information in a format that you feel is appropriate to the assessment
 - Do you have any questions about this assessment?"
- Commence Work Project assessment:
 - The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
 - Participants complete work projects in the most appropriate format
 - Participants must submit Work Project evidence to the assessor before the scheduled due date
- Assessor must assess the participant's evidence against the competency standards specified in each Element of Competency and their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has provided evidence to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Oral Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of oral questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines.

- Prepare Assessment Record for Oral Questioning. One record for each candidate:
 - Enter Student name
 - Enter Assessor name
 - Enter Location
- Familiarise self with Questions to be asked
- Prepare assessment location (table and chairs) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Oral Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):
"These oral questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.
There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability and I will record whether or not you have answered correctly.

We have 60 minutes for this assessment.

- I will give you feedback at the end of the assessment
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- Commence Oral Questioning assessment:
 - Complete Assessment Record for the Oral Questioning by:
 - a) Ticking PC or NYC, as appropriate
 - b) Entering ‘Remarks’ as required
 - c) Completing Oral Questioning within 60 minutes
- Complete Oral Questioning and provide feedback to candidate
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Written Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of written questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Familiarise self with Questions and Answers provided
- Print and distribute copies of ‘Written Questions’ for participants. Ideally this should take place with adequate time for participants to answer all questions before the expected due date
- Explain Written Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a ‘X’ is identified, please input appropriate information):

“These written questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability.

You may refer to your subject materials, however where possible try to utilise your existing knowledge when answering questions.

Where you are unsure of questions, please ask the Assessor for further instruction. This may be answering the question orally or asking the assessor to redefine the question.

We have X time for this assessment:

- The due date for completion of this assessment is X
- On this date you must forward the completed questions to the assessor by X time on the date of X
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
- Participants may record written answers (where possible)
- Participants must submit the written answers to the assessor before the scheduled due date

- Assessor must assess the participant's written answers against the model answers provided as a guide, or their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has answered the questions to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Observation Checklist

These specifications apply to the use of the Observation Checklist in determining competency for candidates.

Only an approved assessor is authorised to complete the Observation Checklist.

The assessor is required to observe the participant, ideally in a simulated environment or their practical workplace setting and record their performance (or otherwise) of the competencies listed on the Observation Checklist for the Competency Unit.

To complete the Observation Checklist the Assessor must:

- Insert name of candidate
- Insert assessor name
- Insert identify of location where observations are being undertaken
- Insert date/s of observations – may be single date or multiple dates
- Place a tick in either the 'Yes' or 'No' box for each listed Performance Criteria to indicate the candidate has demonstrated/not demonstrated that skill
- Provide written (and verbal) feedback to candidate – as/if appropriate
- Sign and date the form
- Present form to candidate for them to sign and date
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Observation Checklist.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the participant.

Specifications for Third Party Statement

These specifications relate to the use of a relevant workplace person to assist in determining competency for candidates.

The Third Party Statement is to be supplied by the assessor to a person in the workplace who supervises and/or works closely with the participant.

This may be their Supervisor, the venue manager, the Department Manager or similar.

The Third Party Statement asks the Supervisor to record what they believe to be the competencies of the participant based on their workplace experience of the participant. This experience may be gained through observation of their workplace performance, feedback from others, inspection of candidate's work etc.

A meeting must take place between the Assessor and the Third Party to explain and demonstrate the use of the Third Party Statement.

To complete the Third Party Verification Statement the Assessor must:

- Insert candidate name
- Insert name and contact details of the Third Party
- Tick the box to indicate the relationship of the Third Party to the candidate
- Present the partially completed form to the Third Party for them to finalise
- Collect the completed form from the Third Party
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Third Party Statement.

The Third Party must:

- Record their belief regarding candidate ability/competency as either:
 - Pass Competent = Yes
 - Not Yet Competent = No
 - Unsure about whether candidate is competent or not = Not Sure
- Meet briefly with the assessor to discuss and/or clarify the form.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the candidate.

A separate Third Party Statement is required for each Competency Unit undertaken by the candidate.

Competency standard

UNIT TITLE: ADMINISTER A BILLING AND SETTLEMENT PLAN		NOMINAL HOURS: 40
UNIT NUMBER: D2.TTA.CL2.02		
UNIT DESCRIPTOR: This unit deals with skills and knowledge required to administer a Billing and Settlement Plan (BSP) in relation to the sale of airline tickets. The primary focus of this unit is the BSP system designed to facilitate procedures between agencies and the International Air Transport Association (IATA).		
ELEMENTS AND PERFORMANCE CRITERIA		UNIT VARIABLE AND ASSESSMENT GUIDE
Element 1: Identify a Billing and Settlement Plan (BSP) 1.1 Define and explain the <i>role and operation of the IATA BSP</i> 1.2 Describe the <i>advantages of the IATA BSP</i> 1.3 Identify <i>participants and suppliers in a BSP</i> 1.4 Identify and explain <i>how the IATA BSP works</i> 1.5 Identify the role and function of <i>IATA BSP documents and manuals</i> 1.6 Expand and explain BSP acronyms and abbreviations 1.7 Explain the Glossary of Terms for the IATA BSP 1.8 Describe the <i>automation of interfaces between agents, airlines and the BSP</i>		Unit Variables The Unit Variables provide advice to interpret the scope and context of this unit of competence, allowing for differences between enterprises and workplaces. It relates to the unit as a whole and facilitates holistic assessment. This unit applies to manual administration (using an Agency Sales Transmittal Form) and on-line administration (via BSPlink) of BSPs within the labour divisions of the hotel and travel industries and may include: 1. Travel agencies 2. Tour operation <i>Role and operation of the IATA BSP</i> refers to: • Simplifying and facilitating the selling, reporting and remitting procedures associated with sales of airline tickets • Increased financial control for participants • Improved cash flow for airlines using the BSP system • Enabling a central point for the flow of funds and data between agents and airlines • Providing for payment of a single remittance to cover payments due to all airlines to whom payment is owed.

1.9 Describe <i>IATA management of the BSP</i> Element 2: Comply with IATA BSP reporting procedures 2.1 Identify <i>required submission dates</i> 2.2 Describe <i>accountable transactions</i> 2.3 Complete <i>AST form</i> 2.4 Complete <i>Group Sales Summary Form (GSS)</i> 2.5 Process <i>airlines' own accounting memoranda</i> 2.6 Process <i>Missing Traffic Document Report form</i> 2.7 Process <i>Returned Documents form</i> Element 3: Comply with IATA BSP billings and statements requirements 3.1 Process <i>Agents' Billings</i> 3.2 Process <i>refund documentation</i> Element 4: Comply with IATA BSP agents' remittance procedures 4.1 Implement <i>agents' remittance procedures</i> 4.2 Handle <i>irregularities and defaults</i>	<i>Advantages of the IATA BSP</i> refers to: • Simplification of reporting and payment procedures • Reduced time required compared to traditional billing and settlement procedures • Cost-saving through the use of standardised documents and procedures including electronic transmissions • Increased financial and stock control • Improved efficiency for businesses and passengers • Links to the global distribution system (GDS) thereby reducing/eliminating potential for stock/ticket loss. <i>Participants and suppliers in a BSP</i> may include: • IATA and BSP management • All airlines including IATA members and non-members • All accredited IATA agents in the BSP country of operation • Certain non-accredited IATA agents • General (non-airline) sales agents and airport handling agents subject to nomination by the airline they represent and entry into the IATA standard agreement • Data Processing Centre (DPC) • Clearing Bank • Standard Traffic Document Distributor • Standard Traffic Document Security printer • Automated Ticketing System Provider • Other travel and tourism industry sectors.
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	<i>How the IATA BSP works</i> is described in the IAIA BSP Manual for Agents as, and under the following: • Stage 1 • Stage 2 • Stage 3 • Stage 4 • Stage 5 • Stage 6. <i>IATA BSP documents and manuals</i> include: • Standard Traffic Documents (STDs): ▪ Automated Tickets – including Off-Premise Transitional Automated Ticket (OPTAT) and Off-Premise Automated Ticket/Boarding Pass Version 2 ▪ Electronic Tickets ▪ Multiple Purpose Documents (MPDs) • Standard Administrative Forms (SAFs): ▪ Agency Sales Transmittal (AST) ▪ Refund Application/Authority and Refund Notice ▪ Standard Credit Card Charge Form (CCCF) • Forms raised by airlines: ▪ Agency Debit Memo (ADM) ▪ Agency Credit Memo (ACM) • BSP Calendar – indicating reporting periods, remittance dates and airline settlement dates • BSP Manual for Agents
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	• BSPlink Manuals • Local Procedures/Information, as applicable to individual countries • Need to maintain stocks of BSP documents, including identification of forms available on-line through BSPlink. <i>Automation of interfaces between agents, airlines and the BSP refers to:</i> • BSPlink – including advantages and functions of BSPlink and automation requirements. <i>IATA management of the BSP includes:</i> • Role of Industry Distribution and Financial Services (IDFS) • BSP management • Role of local BSP manager. <i>Required submission dates should relate to:</i> • Annual BSP calendar • Penalties for late submission • Options for more regular reporting. <i>Complete AST form involves adhering to IATA requirements as stated in the BSP Manual for Agents which may include:</i> • Completion Procedures • Nil Entries • “No Sales” Reports • Recording Credit Transaction Issues in AST • Calculation of face value • Contents and Preparation of AST • Timely submission
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- Automated Methods of Reporting
- Stapling of Documents
- Using AST Envelope.

as well as:

- Compiling necessary documentation and information
- Checking for accuracy
- Ensuring all transaction details are recorded
- Reporting discrepancies
- Keeping and filing documentation in accordance with BSP requirements.

Complete Group Sales Summary Form (GSS) involves adhering to IATA requirements as stated in the BSP Manual for Agents which include:

- Completion Procedures
- Reporting

as well as

- Compiling necessary documentation and information
- Checking for accuracy
- Ensuring all transaction details are recorded
- Reporting discrepancies
- Keeping and filing documentation in accordance with BSP requirements.

Process airlines' own accounting memoranda refers to:

- Reporting of ADM/ACMs
- Disagreement procedure
- Processing of ADM/ACMs.

- *Processes Agents' Billings* involves adhering to IATA requirements as stated in the BSP.

	Manual for Agents which include: • Billing Statement • Billing Analysis • Special Billings/Deferred Billing • Dispatch of Billings • Disputed Billings • Statement of Annual Sales Volume and Traffic Document Usage • Paying Computer Reservation System (CRS) Fees. <i>Refund documentation</i> must include: • Refund Notice • Refund Application/Authority. <i>Implement agents' remittance procedures</i> refers to adhering to IATA requirements as stated in the BSP Manual for Agents which includes: • Remittance Date, including requirements that apply to BSP participating Airlines and Non BSP participating IATA Member Airlines • Method of Remittance/Direct Debiting • Post-Settlement Errors Discovered By Agent • Post-Settlement Errors Discovered By The BSP Airline • Credit Notes • Disputed Amounts • Net Reporting/Remit Schemes as well as • Compiling necessary documentation and information
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- Checking for accuracy
- Ensuring all transaction details are recorded
- Reporting discrepancies.

Keeping and filing documentation in accordance with BSP requirements.

Irregularities and defaults refers to:

- Incomplete/Overdue AST
- Late Reported/Unreported Transactions
- Overdue or Dishonoured Remittance
- Notices of Irregularity
- Default Action
- Reinstatement/Action Following the Default
- Administrative Charges
- Reviews by, and function of, Travel Agency Commissioner
- Arbitration.

Assessment Guide

The following skills and knowledge must be assessed as part of this unit:

- Understand the role of IATA in BSP
- Detailed knowledge of IATA agency accreditation requirements
- Ability to use the BSP manual and electronic procedures, including with BSPlink
- Ability to meet BSP reporting timeframes/calendars
- Ability to comply with BSP documentation in hard copy and electronic formats
- General knowledge relating to airfares and ticketing
- Arithmetic skills to enable calculations and report generation.

	Linkages To Other Units • Apply advanced airfare rules and procedures • Construct and ticket domestic airfares • Construct and ticket promotional international airfares • Construct and ticket regular international airfares. Critical Aspects of Assessment Evidence of the following is essential: • Demonstrated ability to comply with reporting procedures as required by IATA BSP • Demonstrated ability to process billings and statements as required by IATA BSP • Demonstrated ability to comply with agents' remittance procedures as required by IATA BSP • Demonstrated ability to handle irregularities and defaults as required by IATA BSP. Context of Assessment This unit may be assessed on or off the job: • Assessment should include practical demonstration of administration of IATA BSP either in the workplace or through a simulation activity, supported by a range of methods to assess underpinning knowledge • Assessment must relate to the individual's work area or area of responsibility. Resource Implications • Training and assessment to include access to a real or simulated workplace and use of actual IATA BSP systems including BSPlink, documents and procedures • Access to workplace standards, procedures, policies, guidelines, tools and equipment.
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	Assessment Methods The following methods may be used to assess competency for this unit: • Observation of practical candidate performance • Simulated exercises • Portfolio of reports and other relevant BSP documentation • Oral and written questions • Third party reports completed by a supervisor • Project and assignment work. Key Competencies in this Unit <i>Level 1 = competence to undertake tasks effectively</i> <i>Level 2 = competence to manage tasks</i> <i>Level 3 = competence to use concepts for evaluating</i>		
	Key Competencies	Level	Examples
	Collecting, organising and analysing information	2	Compile documentation and information required to process reports and comply with procedural requirements
	Communicating ideas and information	1	Discuss irregularities with others
	Planning and organising activities	2	Meet IATA calendar dates and schedules
	Working with others and in teams	1	Liaise with staff to compile report and other information; cooperate with others to investigate irregularities

	Using mathematical ideas and techniques	1	Calculate and report settlement and billing figures
	Solving problems	1	Resolve disputes and irregularities
	Using technology	1	Use the computerised reservation system and BSPlink

Oral questions

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Administer a billing and settlement plan D2.TTA.CL2.02
Instructions	1. Ask student questions from the attached list to confirm knowledge, as necessary 2. Place tick in boxes to reflect student achievement (Pass Competent 'PC' or Not Yet Competent 'NYC') 3. Write short-form student answer in the space provided for each question.

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
1. What is the role of the IATA BSP?	☐	☐
2. Explain the role of the IATA BSP and how it benefits airlines .	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
3. Describe the functions of a GDS for a travel agent.	☐	☐
4. Explain the role of the GDS and DPC in the BSP process.	☐	☐
5. What does V-MPD stand for and what is it used for?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
6. Name and explain three commonly used abbreviations or acronyms used in the BSP.	☐	☐
7. What is an 'accountable transaction' in the BSP?	☐	☐
8. What is <i>BSPlink</i> and who uses it?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
9. What is the role of the Local BSP Manager?	☐	☐
10. What information is contained in a BSP calendar?	☐	☐
11. What is an example of an 'accountable transaction' in the IATA BSP?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
12. Why are Agents no longer required to complete an Agency Sales Transmittal form or a Group Sales Summary form?	☐	☐
13. Describe how an agent can access airline ADMs and ACMs.	☐	☐
14. What information appears in the Agent Billing Analysis?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
15. What is the difference between a Refund Notice and a Refund Application?	☐	☐
16. What is the purpose of the Agent Remittance date on the BSP calendar?	☐	☐
17. What is the consequence for an agent that received four Notices of Irregularity within a 12 month period?	☐	☐

Written questions

Administer a billing and settlement plan – D2.TTA.CL2.02

Student Name: _____

Answer all the following questions and submit to your Trainer.

1. What does a BSP allow travel agents to do?

2. List three advantages for travel agents using the IATA BSP.

3. List two of the requirements of a GDS as a Ticket System Provider to participate in the IATA BSP.

4. What is the difference between an 'Agent Billing Analysis' and an 'Airline Billing Analysis'?

5. Briefly explain the different systems an agent uses to issue an electronic ticket and a Virtual MPD.

6. What is a PNR?

7. Describe the role of the Clearing Bank in the BSP.

8. List three functions that agents can perform in *BSPlink*.

9. List two examples of functions performed by a Local BSP Manager.

10. Explain the difference between the Agent Billing and the Agent Remittance dates on the BSP calendar.

11. What is a V-MPD and where is it issued?

12. Prior to the introduction of electronic ticketing, what was the purpose of the Agency Sales Transmittal form?

13. What is an Agent Group?

14. What is the difference between an ADM and an ACM?

15. Why is it important for an agent to carefully check their Billing Analysis?

16. What happens after an airline authorises a refund to an agent?

17. What should an agent do if they discover a billing error after the remittance date?

18. What are the consequences for an agent that is declared in default?

Answers to written questions

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The following are model answers only – Trainers/Assessors must use discretion when determining whether or not an answer provided by a Student is acceptable or not.

1. What does a BSP allow travel agents to do?

An agent can sell many airline travel products and report these sales to each airline through one central system.

2. List three advantages for travel agents using the IATA BSP.

Responses should include:

- Agents will receive one report for all sales on all BSP airlines
- Agents will make a single payment for all BSP airlines
- The GDS reports electronic ticket sales to BSP electronically
- Save money on paper and other resources
- The IATA BSP is monitoring the process and acts as a neutral body
- Simplifies staff training through courses organised locally specific to BSP
- A cost-effective system for selling the products and services of BSP Airlines
- Agents can sell tickets on a wide range of airlines, including interline travel
- Agents can spend more time selling airline tickets rather than on administration.

3. List two of the requirements of a GDS as a Ticket System Provider to participate in the IATA BSP.

Responses should include:

- Ability to issue electronic tickets in accordance with IATA requirements
- Ability to provide data in the required format to the specified Data Processing Centre
- Ability to stop the issuance of electronic tickets of agents within 24 hours, if required by the BSP Manager.

4. What is the difference between an 'Agent Billing Analysis' and an 'Airline Billing Analysis'?

An 'Agents Billing Analysis' includes all reports ticket sales and refunds during the Billing Period. The Airline Billing Analysis contains all tickets and refunds issued for the airline by all its agents during a billing period.

5. Briefly explain the different systems an agent uses to issue an electronic ticket and a Virtual MPD.

Electronic tickets are issued in a GDS. V-MPDs are issued in BSPlink.

6. What is a PNR?

A reservation number in a GDS that contains passenger details, itinerary and ticketing information.

7. Describe the role of the Clearing Bank in the BSP.

The Clearing Bank receives remittances from agents and settles funds to airlines.

8. List three functions that agents can perform in BSPlink.

Responses may include:

- Downloading of BSP billing and sales reports
- V-MPD issuance
- Instantaneous set-up and maintenance of ticketing authorities with immediate messages to CRS
- Issuance of refund applications and authorities for review and approval by the Airline concerned
- On-line authorisation of electronic refund application
- Electronic access to BSP reports and statistics.

9. List two examples of functions performed by a Local BSP Manager.

Responses may include:

- Provide agents with access to BSPlink and instructions on how to use the system
- Advise agents and the DPC on BSP procedures
- Impose penalties for non-compliance
- Publish the local BSP calendar.

10. Explain the difference between the Agent Billing and the Agent Remittance dates.

The Agent Billing date is the date that the Agent can access their Billing report from BSPlink. The Agent Remittance date is the date that payment is taken from the Agent's account for this billing.

11. What is a V-MPD and where is it issued?

Virtual Multi-Purpose document is used to make payment to an airline for non-air services. A V-MPD is issued through BSPlink.

12. Prior to the introduction of electronic ticketing, what was the purpose of the Agency Sales Transmittal form?

Agents reported the use of all documents and forms for the reporting period and returned this to BSP.

13. What is an Agent Group?

An Accredited Agency with multiple users and locations.

14. What is the difference between an ADM and an ACM?

- An ADM is issued by an airline when an Agent owes money
- An ACM is issued by an airline when the Airline owes the Agent money.

15. Why is it important for the agent to carefully check their Billing Analysis?

The DPC does not verify the accuracy of the information from the agent GDS and it is possible that the agent may have made errors when issuing tickets.

16. What happens after an airline authorises a refund to an agent?

The refund is sent to the DPC for processing in the next billing period.

17. What should an agent do if they discover a billing error after the remittance date?

The agent will need to contact the BSP Airline concerned with an adjustment request. If the BSP Airline agrees with the agent's adjustment claim, an ADM or an ACM is raised for the amount over or under-remitted.

18. What are the consequences for an agent that is declared in default?

The Clearing Bank and BSP airlines are notified. STDs are not supplied. Payment is demanded by the Agent Administrator.

Observation checklist

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Administer a billing and settlement plan D2.TTA.CL2.02
Dates of observation	
Instructions	- Over a period of time observe the student completing each of the following tasks: - Identify a Billing and Settlement Plan (BSP) - Comply with IATA BSP reporting procedures - Comply with IATA BSP billings and statements requirements - Comply with IATA BSP agents' remittance procedures - Enter the date on which the tasks were undertaken - Place a tick in the box to show they completed each aspect of the task to the standard expected in the enterprise - Complete the feedback sections of the form, if required.

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 1: Identify a Billing and Settlement Plan (BSP)		
Define and explain the role and operation of the IATA BSP	☐	☐
Describe the advantages of the IATA BSP	☐	☐
Identify participants and suppliers in a BSP	☐	☐
Identify and explain how the IATA BSP works	☐	☐
Identify the role and function of IATA BSP documents and manuals	☐	☐
Expand and explain BSP acronyms and abbreviations	☐	☐
Explain the Glossary of Terms for the IATA BSP	☐	☐
Describe the automation of interfaces between agents, airlines and the BSP	☐	☐
Describe IATA management of the BSP	☐	☐

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 2: Comply with IATA BSP reporting procedures		
Identify required submission dates	☐	☐
Describe accountable transactions	☐	☐
Complete AST form	☐	☐
Complete Group Sales Summary Form (GSS)	☐	☐
Process airlines' own accounting memoranda	☐	☐
Process Missing Traffic Document Report form	☐	☐
Process Returned Documents form	☐	☐
Element 3: Comply with IATA BSP billings and statements requirements		
Process Agents' Billings	☐	☐
Process refund documentation	☐	☐
Element 4: Comply with IATA BSP agents' remittance procedures		
Implement agents' remittance procedures	☐	☐
Handle irregularities and defaults	☐	☐
Did the student's overall performance meet the standard?	☐	☐

Feedback to student and trainer/assessor**Strengths:****Improvements needed:****General comments:****Candidate signature****Date****Assessor signature****Date**

Third Party Statement

Student name:			
Name of third party:		Contact no:	
Relationship to student:	☐ Employer ☐ Supervisor ☐ Colleague ☐ Other <i>Please specify: _____</i> <i>Please do not complete the form if you are a relative, close friend or have a conflict of interest]</i>		
Unit of competency:	Administer a billing and settlement plan D2.TTA.CL2.02		
The student is being assessed against industry competency standards and we are seeking your support in the judgement of their competence. Please answer these questions as a record of their performance while working with you. Thank you for your time.			
Do you believe the trainee has demonstrated the following skills? <i>(tick the correct response]</i>	Yes	No	Not sure
Identified the participants and suppliers in a BSP	☐	☐	☐
Identified and accessed BSP documents and manuals	☐	☐	☐
Correctly used of BSP acronyms, terms and abbreviations	☐	☐	☐
Accesses and used BSPLink	☐	☐	☐
Identified submission dates for reporting and remittance	☐	☐	☐
Accessed and processed airline accounting memorandum including ADMs and ACMS	☐	☐	☐
Accessed and checked agent billing statements	☐	☐	☐
Processed refunds for airline tickets	☐	☐	☐
Implemented remittance procedure	☐	☐	☐
Identified potential irregularities and defaults	☐	☐	☐

Comments/feedback from Third Party to Trainer/Assessor:

Third party signature:

Date:

Send to:

Competency recording sheet

Name of Student		
Name of Assessor/s		
Unit of Competency	Administer a billing and settlement plan	D2.TTA.CL2.02
Date assessment commenced		
Date assessment finalised		
Assessment decision	Pass Competent / Not Yet Competent (Circle one)	
Follow up action required (Insert additional work and assessment required to achieve competency)		
Comments/observations by assessor/s		

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 1: Identify a Billing and Settlement Plan (BSP)						
Define and explain the role and operation of the IATA BSP						
Describe the advantages of the IATA BSP						
Identify participants and suppliers in a BSP						
Identify and explain how the IATA BSP works						
Identify the role and function of IATA BSP documents and manuals						
Expand and explain BSP acronyms and abbreviations						
Explain the Glossary of Terms for the IATA BSP						
Describe the automation of interfaces between agents, airlines and the BSP						
Describe IATA management of the BSP						

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 2: Comply with IATA BSP reporting procedures						
Identify required submission dates						
Describe accountable transactions						
Complete AST form						
Complete Group Sales Summary Form (GSS)						
Process airlines' own accounting memoranda						
Process Missing Traffic Document Report form						
Process Returned Documents form						

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 3: Comply with IATA BSP billings and statements requirements						
Process Agents' Billings						
Process refund documentation						
Element 4: Comply with IATA BSP agents' remittance procedures						
Implement agents' remittance procedures						
Handle irregularities and defaults						
Candidate signature:			Date:			
Assessor signature:			Date:			

